

3. Refrain from formatting your e-mail with coloured text and background colours or images in your day-to-day communications. Your colour and formatting choices can make your e-mails impossible to read. In addition, formatting could make your e-mails difficult to reply to without having to go through a procedure to convert your e-mail to plaintext first.

Often, when people click 'Reply', they have to deal with your formatting carrying over to their reply, which makes communicating with you unnecessarily more difficult. Why would you expect people to convert your e-mail just to read and respond to you? They probably will not!

Using large background graphics that take forever to download, especially if you have a dial-up connection (which is still more common than most of us may like to believe) is simply inconsiderate. If you do feel the uncontrollable need to use any type of formatting in your daily communications, do so sparingly. So, for those of you who want to e-mail *Digit*, send your e-mail in plaintext!

4. On those rare occasions where it is necessary to send a group of people the very same e-mail, as a courtesy to those you are sending the mail to, list all the recipients' e-mail addresses in the BCC (Blind Carbon Copy) field. When an e-mail address is designated in the BCC field, the recipient will get a copy of the e-mail while their e-mail address remains invisible to the other recipients of the e-mail—some or all of whom they may or may not know.

Long lists of e-mail addresses at the beginning of any e-mail is an immediate sign that the sender is either a novice/Newbie—or doesn't care to respect other's privacy. None of which, we're sure you'll agree, are complimentary perceptions! E-mail addresses are like phone numbers. Only the owner of the e-mail address or phone number should be able to authorise who they want to have it and make it public to.